

But after 4 years¹ some of the clergy and some of the senate,
in particular Festus and Probinus, full of zeal
and craft, |
brought charges against Symmachus and suborned false witnesses
whom they sent to King Theodoric,
the heretic, |
at Ravenna to accuse the blessed Symmachus; and they recalled
Laurentius stealthily
to Rome, |
after the accusation had been drawn up at Rome; and they created
a schism and
a party withdrew itself from | the clergy was divided again and
communion with Symmachus.² | some communicated with Sym-
machus and some with Lauren-
tius.

Then the senators Festus and Probinus sent a report to the king
and asked King Theodoric to | and began to negotiate with the
send Peter of Altinum³ as an | king to send an inspector to the
inspector to the apostolic see. | apostolic see. Then the king
sent Peter, bishop of the town
of Altinum, although the canons
forbade it.

future papal elections. During the synod Laurentius was appointed bishop of Nocera.
Jaffé, *Regesta*, vol. I, p. 96. Hefele, *op. cit.*, vol. II, p. 958.

¹ In fact early in 501.

² The first accusation brought by the malcontents against Symmachus concerned
the date of Easter. Symmachus had celebrated that festival in 501 on March 25,
following the old Roman calendar. Jaffé, *Regesta*, p. 97, 754. His adversaries com-
plained that he should have adopted the Greek reckoning, which brought the date to
April 22. Symmachus went to Rimini to lay his case before Theodoric and while there
learned of other and graver charges which were being preferred against him: *viz.*,
violation of chastity and misuse of church property. Thereupon, without waiting to
face Theodoric, he fled back to Rome by night and entrenched himself in the buildings of
the Vatican. The hostile party took advantage of his flight to prevail upon Theodoric
to send a "visitor" or inspector to Rome in order to celebrate Easter at the proper
season, as the emperor Honorius had done at the time of the dissension between Boni-
face I and Eulalius. *Supra*, p. 89, n. 4; p. 90. The act, however, was tantamount to a
declaration that the see of Rome was vacant or contested. Symmachus was bound to
resent it as a negation of all his rights. Duchesne, *op. cit.*, p. 264, n. 8. Jaffé, *ibid.*, p. 97.

³ The modern Altino near Venice.